

7. Physical & Motor Development

Observable language for gross motor, fine motor, and physical participation.

Document what the child can do and what level of support was needed. Describe rather than compare to peers. Never say 'can't' — describe what was observed instead.

Gross Motor — Large Movement		
walked on level surface independently	ran with coordination	ran with frequent stumbles or falls
climbed the ladder with two-hand support	climbed independently	jumped with both feet leaving the ground
jumped from a low step	hopped on one foot	walked up stairs alternating feet
walked up stairs with same foot leading	walked up stairs holding the railing	kicked a ball with dominant foot
threw a ball overhand	caught a large ball	balanced on one foot for ____ seconds
rode a balance bike or tricycle	navigated obstacles in the environment	walked on uneven surfaces with support

Fine Motor — Small Movement & Hand Use		
grasped objects using full hand	used pincer grasp (thumb and index finger)	held a crayon or marker with fist grip
held a writing tool with three-finger grip	transferred objects between hands	stacked ____ blocks before tower fell
completed a ____ piece puzzle independently	completed puzzle with adult hand-over-hand support	cut along a straight line
cut along a curved line	fastened a large button	zipped and unzipped a jacket
opened and closed a container independently	used scissors with both hands stabilizing	drew a recognizable shape
drew a figure with distinct parts	used a fork or spoon independently	opened a snack bag independently

Physical Participation in Routines		
removed shoes and placed in cubby independently	needed hand-over-hand support to remove shoes	washed hands with verbal prompting
washed hands independently	served food with a spoon independently	needed support to navigate the cafeteria line
carried a lunch tray with two hands	sat at table for duration of meal	required adapted seating to participate
used adapted utensil provided by family	moved between carpet and table independently	required a mobility device to navigate the classroom

